Theme 4 title2 New Believer

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THE PROMISE IN THE GARDEN
Discovering the First Clues About Your Savior
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Why This Book Exists

When you first start following Jesus, you learn about the cross. You learn about the empty tomb. You learn about forgiveness. You learn about grace. It is wonderful. It is life-changing. It is the good news.

But then you might wonder, "Where did this all begin? When did God first plan to save us? Was the cross an afterthought? Was it a backup plan?" The answer is no. The cross was not an afterthought. It was not a backup plan. It was the plan from the very beginning. And the first clues are found in a garden.

This book is for you. You are new to the faith. You are building your foundation. Over the next 30 days, we are going to look at the first clues about your Savior. We are going to look at the promise in the garden. We are going to see how God planned the rescue from the very start. And we are going to see that your Savior was promised long before He was born.

The Value You Will Get

By the end of this book, you will not be confused about the beginning of the story. You will see the garden. You will see the promise. You will see the plan. You will understand the first clues. You will understand the first promise. You will understand why the garden matters today. You will have a new confidence in your faith. You will have a new love for your Bible. And you will have a new appreciation for the promise in the garden.

How to Use This Guide

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the promise. Read the proof. Read why it matters for your new life. Read the faith builder. Read the prayer. If you are not sure how to pray, just read the words out loud. God hears honest words. He is not looking for fancy language. He is looking for your heart.

Day 01: The Garden of God

The Promise (OT)
"Now the LORD God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed." - Genesis 2:8 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God planted a garden. He planted it in Eden. He put the man there. It was a place of beauty. It was a place of life. It was a place of peace. It was a place where God walked with His people. It was a place where the story began.

The Proof (NT)
"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son, who came from the Father, full of grace and truth." - John 1:14

Jesus is the new garden. He is the new dwelling place. He is the place where God walks with His people. The garden in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are wandering in a desert. You might feel like you are lost. Remember the garden. Remember Jesus. He is the place where God dwells with you. He is the place where you can walk with God.

Faith Builder
Find a quiet place. Sit down. Close your eyes. Imagine a beautiful garden. Imagine walking with God in the cool of the day. Write down what that feels like.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the garden. Thank you for the place where you walked with your people. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you that He is the place where I can walk with you. Help me to walk with you today. Amen.

Day 02: The Tree of Life

The Promise (OT)
"In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." - Genesis 2:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

There were two trees in the garden. The tree of life. The tree of the knowledge of good and evil. One was a tree of life. One was a tree of death. One was a tree of obedience. One was a tree of disobedience. One was a tree of blessing. One was a tree of curse. It was a choice. It was a test. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Then Jesus said to them, 'Very truly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you. Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day.'" - John 6:53-54

Jesus is the tree of life. He is the one who gives eternal life. The tree of life in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want life. You might want eternal life. You might want to eat from the tree of life. Remember the garden. Remember Jesus. He is the tree of life. He gives life. He gives eternal life. He gives himself.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a tree. Write the word "Life" on the leaves. Thank Jesus for being the tree of life. Thank Him for giving you eternal life.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the tree of life. Thank you for giving me life. Thank you for giving me eternal life. Help me to eat from your tree. Help me to feed on your truth. Help me to feast on your love. Amen.

Day 03: The Command of God

The Promise (OT)
"And the LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.'" - Genesis 2:16-17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God gave a command. He gave a rule. He gave a test. He said, "You are free to eat from any tree. But you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. For when you eat from it, you will certainly die." It was a command. It was a boundary. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He broke the command. He ate the fruit. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus obeyed. He kept the command. He never sinned. He brought righteousness into the world. The command in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are always breaking the rules. You might feel like you are always failing. You might feel like you are always disobeying. Remember Jesus. He obeyed for you. He kept the command for you. He brought righteousness for you.

Faith Builder
Think of a rule you struggle to keep. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus kept this rule for me." Thank Him for His obedience.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for obeying. Thank you for keeping the command. Thank you for bringing righteousness. Thank you for taking my disobedience. Help me to live in your obedience. Help me to live in your righteousness. Amen.

Day 04: The Helper of God

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for him.'" - Genesis 2:18 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." He said, "I will make a helper suitable for him." He created the woman. He created Eve. He created a companion. He created a helper. He created a partner. It was a gift. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another advocate to help you and be with you forever—the Spirit of truth." - John 14:16-17

Jesus promised a helper. He promised the Holy Spirit. He promised an advocate. He promised a companion. The helper in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is the Holy Spirit.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be lonely. You might be alone. You might need help. Remember the helper. Remember the Holy Spirit. He is with you. He is your advocate. He is your companion. You are not alone.

Faith Builder
Write down one thing you need help with. Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to help you. Thank Him for being your helper.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the helper. Thank you for the Holy Spirit. Thank you for being with me. Thank you for being my advocate. Thank you for being my companion. Help me to know the Spirit. Help me to listen to the Spirit. Help me to walk with the Spirit. Amen.

Day 05: The Rib of God

The Promise (OT)
"But for Adam no suitable helper was found. So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and then closed up the

place with flesh. Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man." - Genesis 2:20-22 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God caused Adam to fall into a deep sleep. He took a rib. He made a woman. He brought her to the man. It was a strange story. It was a beautiful story. It was a promise. It pointed to something greater.

The Proof (NT)
"For we are members of his body. 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.' This is a profound mystery—but I am talking about Christ and the church." - Ephesians 5:30-32

Paul says something amazing. He says the story of Adam and Eve is a mystery. He says it is about Christ and the church. Jesus slept in death. He took a wound in his side. He created the church. The rib in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are a part of something. You might feel like you belong. Remember the rib. Remember the church. You are part of the body of Christ. You are created from his side. You belong to him.

Faith Builder
Think about your church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the church. Thank you for creating the church. Thank you for the wound in your side. Thank you for the blood and water that flowed. Thank you for making me part of your body. Help me to love the church. Help me to serve the church. Help me to be the church. Amen.

Day 06: The Serpent of Old

The Promise (OT)
"Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God really say, "You must not eat from any tree in the garden"?'" - Genesis 3:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The serpent was crafty. He was sneaky. He was deceptive. He questioned God's word. He questioned God's goodness. He twisted the truth. He tempted the woman. It was a trap. It was a test. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"The great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil, or Satan, who leads the whole world astray." - Revelation 12:9

The serpent in Genesis is the devil. He is Satan. He is the ancient serpent. He is the one who leads the world astray. But Jesus defeated him. Jesus crushed his head. The serpent in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be tempted. You might be deceived. You might be lied to. Remember the serpent. Remember the defeat. Jesus crushed his head. He defeated him. He won the victory. You are on the winning side.

Faith Builder
Think of a lie you have believed about yourself. Write it down. Then write down a truth from God's word that replaces it. Say the truth out loud.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for defeating the serpent. Thank you for crushing his head. Thank you for winning the victory. Help me to resist temptation. Help me to see through the lies. Help me to trust your word. Amen.

Day 07: The Fall of Man

The Promise (OT)
"When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it." - Genesis 3:6 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The woman saw the fruit. She saw it was good. She saw it was pleasing. She saw it was desirable. She took it. She ate it. She gave it to her husband. He ate it. They disobeyed. They fell. They sinned. It was a mistake. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam fell. He disobeyed. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus did not fall. He obeyed. He brought righteousness into the world. The fall in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have fallen. You might have sinned. You might have made a mistake. Remember Jesus. He did not fall. He stood. He stood for you. He took your fall. He took your sin. He took your mistake. He gives you his standing.

Faith Builder
Think of a mistake you have made. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus took my mistake. He gives me his standing." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for standing. Thank you for not falling. Thank you for taking my fall. Thank you for taking my sin. Thank you for taking my mistake. Help me to stand in you. Help me to live in your righteousness. Amen.

Day 08: The Fig Leaves

The Promise (OT)
"Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves." - Genesis 3:7 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Adam and Eve ate the fruit. Their eyes were opened. They realized they were naked. They were ashamed. They were afraid. So they sewed fig leaves together. They made coverings for themselves. They tried to fix their own problem. They tried to cover their own shame. It was a failed attempt. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the true covering. He is the true clothing. He covers our shame. He covers our sin. He covers our nakedness. The fig leaves in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to cover your shame. You might be trying to hide your mistakes. You might be trying to fix yourself. Remember the fig leaves. They do not work. Remember Jesus. He is the true covering. He covers your shame. He covers your sin. He covers your nakedness.

Faith Builder
Think of a shame you are carrying. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus covers my shame." Crumple up the paper. Throw it away. Thank Jesus for His covering.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for covering me. Thank you for clothing me. Thank you for taking away my shame. Thank you for taking away my sin. Help me to stop sewing fig leaves. Help me to rest in your covering. Amen.

Day 09: The Question of God

The Promise (OT)

"But the LORD God called to the man, 'Where are you?'" - Genesis 3:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God called to Adam. He said, "Where are you?" It was a question. It was a search. It was a pursuit. God was looking for Adam. He was seeking him. He was calling him. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the seeker. He is the one who comes looking. He is the one who calls. He is the one who saves. The question in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be hiding. You might be running. You might be lost. Where are you? Remember the question. Remember the seeker. Jesus is looking for you. He is calling you. He is pursuing you. You can stop hiding. You can come out.

Faith Builder
Find a quiet place. Sit down. Close your eyes. Ask God, "Where are you?" Then listen. Write down what you sense He is saying to you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for seeking me. Thank you for finding me. Thank you for saving me. Help me to stop hiding. Help me to come out. Help me to answer your call. Amen.

Day 10: The Promise of God

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God spoke to the serpent. He spoke to the devil. He said, "I will put enmity between you and the woman. Between your offspring and hers. He will crush your head. You will strike his heel." It was a promise. It was a hope. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the offspring. He is the one born of a woman. He is the one who crushed the serpent's head. He is the one who defeated the devil. The promise in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life

You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the deliverer. He crushes the serpent's head. He defeats the devil. He gives you hope.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from God that you are holding onto. Say it out loud. Thank God for keeping His promises.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the serpent's head. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Amen.

Day 11: The Garments of God

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them." - Genesis 3:21 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made garments of skin. He made clothes. He made a covering. An animal had to die. Blood had to be shed. It was a sacrifice. It was a gift. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the garment. He is the sacrifice. He is the covering. His blood was shed. His life was given. The garments in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covering. You might need a garment. You might need a gift. Remember the garments. Remember Jesus. He is the covering. He is the garment. He is the gift. He covers your shame. He covers your sin.

Faith Builder
Put on a favorite piece of clothing. As you put it on, thank Jesus for covering you with His righteousness. Thank Him for the gift of salvation.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the garment. Thank you for the covering. Thank you for the gift. Thank you for shedding your blood. Thank you for giving your life. Help me to wear your garment. Help me to rest in your covering. Amen.

Day 12: The Exile of Man

The Promise (OT)
"So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." - Genesis 3:23 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God banished Adam from the garden. He sent him away. He exiled him. He drove him out. It was a punishment. It was a consequence. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have gained access by faith into this grace in which we now stand." - Romans 5:1-2

Jesus brings us back. He restores our access. He brings us into grace. He brings us into peace. The exile in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel exiled. You might feel banished. You might feel separated. Remember Jesus. He brings you back. He restores your access. He brings you into grace. He brings you into peace.

Faith Builder
Think of a time you felt far from God. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus brings me back." Thank Him for restoring your access to God.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for bringing me back. Thank you for restoring my access. Thank you for bringing me into grace. Thank you for bringing me into peace. Help me to live in your presence. Help me to live in your grace. Amen.

Day 13: The Cherubim of God

The Promise (OT)
"After he drove the man out, he placed on the east side of the Garden of Eden cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life." - Genesis 3:24 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God placed cherubim at the garden. They were angels. They were guards. They had a flaming sword. They guarded the way to the tree of life. They guarded the way to God. It was a barrier. It was a separation. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit. At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:50-51

Jesus removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. He made access to God. The cherubim in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel separated from God. You might feel like there is a barrier. You might feel like there is a flaming sword. Remember Jesus. He removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. You can come to God now.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a curtain. Then draw a line through it, tearing it in two. Write the word "Jesus" on the tear. Thank Him for opening the way to God.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for opening the way. Thank you for removing the barrier. Thank you for tearing the curtain. Help me to come to God. Help me to approach the throne of grace. Help me to live in your presence. Amen.

Day 14: Cain and Abel

The Promise (OT)
"Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him." - Genesis 4:8 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Cain was jealous. He was angry. He killed his brother. He shed innocent blood. It was the first murder. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him." - John 8:44

Cain belonged to the devil. He was a murderer. But Jesus is different. He is the innocent one. He is the one who was killed. He is the one who shed his blood. The murder in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have been hurt by someone. You might have been betrayed. You might have been wounded. Remember Jesus. He was hurt. He was betrayed. He was wounded. He understands. He heals.

Faith Builder
Think of someone who has hurt you. Write their name down. Then pray for them. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for understanding my pain. Thank you for being wounded for me. Thank you for being betrayed for me. Heal my wounds. Heal my pain. Heal my heart. Help me to forgive those who have hurt me. Amen.

Day 15: The Blood of Abel

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD said, 'What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.'" - Genesis 4:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Abel's blood cried out. It cried out for justice. It cried out for vengeance. It cried out from the ground. It was a witness. It was a testimony. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"To Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." - Hebrews 12:24

Jesus' blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy. The blood of Abel is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need forgiveness. You might need grace. You might need mercy. Remember the blood. Remember Jesus. His blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy.

Faith Builder
Think of a sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus' blood speaks forgiveness over me." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for your blood. Thank you for speaking a better word. Thank you for forgiveness. Thank you for grace. Thank you for mercy. Help me to receive your forgiveness. Help me to live in your grace. Help me to extend your mercy. Amen.

Day 16: The Seed of Noah

The Promise (OT)
"Noah, a man of the soil, proceeded to plant a vineyard." - Genesis 9:20 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Noah planted a vineyard. He planted a seed. He planted a crop. He planted a future. It was a new beginning. It was a new start. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)

"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. We are the branches. We bear fruit. The seed in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want to bear fruit. You might want to grow. You might want to be productive. Remember the vine. Remember Jesus. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. Remain in him.

Faith Builder
Think of one way you want to grow in your new life. Write it down. Ask Jesus to help you grow. Thank Him for being the vine.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the vine. Thank you for being the source of growth. Thank you for being the source of fruit. Help me to remain in you. Help me to bear much fruit. Help me to live a fruitful life. Amen.

Day 17: The Covenant of Noah

The Promise (OT)
"I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be destroyed by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth." - Genesis 9:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made a covenant with Noah. He made a promise. He made an agreement. He said, "Never again will all life be destroyed by a flood." It was a covenant. It was a promise. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"In the same way, after the supper he took the cup, saying, 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.'" - Luke 22:20

Jesus made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood." The covenant with Noah is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need an agreement. Remember the covenant. Remember Jesus. He made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He made it with you.

Faith Builder

Write down one promise from the new covenant. For example, "My sins are forgiven." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Thank you for the new agreement. Thank you for your blood. Thank you for your sacrifice. Help me to live in the new covenant. Help me to live in the new promise. Amen.

Day 18: The Rainbow of God

The Promise (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God set a rainbow in the clouds. It was a sign. It was a promise. It was a reminder. It was a covenant. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the book of life. He is the one who judges. He is the one who saves. The rainbow in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a sign. You might need a promise. You might need a reminder. Remember the rainbow. Remember Jesus. He is the sign. He is the promise. He is the reminder. He is the one who saves.

Faith Builder
Draw a rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His promises to you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the rainbow. Thank you for the sign. Thank you for the promise. Thank you for the reminder. Help me to see the rainbow. Help me to remember your promise. Help me to trust your covenant. Amen.

Day 19: The Tower of Babel

The Promise (OT)

"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The people built a tower. They built it with bricks. They built it with mortar. They built it to reach heaven. They built it to make a name for themselves. It was a failure. It was a confusion. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus made a name for himself. He did not build a tower. He did not reach heaven. He came down from heaven. He made a name for himself. He made a name that is above every name. The tower in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to make a name for yourself. You might be trying to reach heaven. You might be trying to build a tower. Remember Jesus. He came down. He made a name. He made a name that is above every name. You do not have to build a tower. You do not have to reach heaven. You can just trust Jesus.

Faith Builder
Think of a way you have tried to earn God's love. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus already made a name for me. I can rest in Him." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for making a name. Thank you for making a name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down. Thank you for reaching me. Help me to stop building towers. Help me to trust your name. Help me to live in your name. Amen.

Day 20: The Promise of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:2-3 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will make you into a great nation. I will bless you. I will make your name great. You will be a blessing. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." It was a promise. It was a hope. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)

"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole world. The promise to Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the fulfillment. He is the hope. He is the future. He is the blessing.

Faith Builder
Think about your family. Write down one way you can be a blessing to them this week. Ask God to help you do it.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Help me to be a blessing to others. Amen.

Day 21: The Faith of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
*"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him

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Day 21: The Faith of Abraham (Continued)

The Promise (OT)
"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness." - Genesis 15:6 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham believed God. He trusted God. He had faith. And God credited it to him as righteousness. Not because Abraham was perfect. Not because Abraham earned it. Because Abraham believed. It was a gift. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"However, to the one who does not work but trusts God who justifies the ungodly, their faith is credited as righteousness." - Romans 4:5

Jesus is the object of our faith. We believe in Him. We trust in Him. And God credits it to us as righteousness. Not because we are perfect. Not because we earned it. Because we believe. The faith of Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might think you have to earn God's love. You might think you have to be good enough. You might think you have to work for it. Remember Abraham. He believed. That was enough. Your faith in Jesus is enough. It is credited to you as righteousness.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "I am made righteous by faith in Jesus, not by my works." Say it out loud. Thank God for this gift.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the gift of righteousness. Thank you that I do not have to earn it. Thank you that I do not have to work for it. Thank you that I just have to believe. Help me to trust in Jesus. Help me to live by faith. Amen.

Day 22: The Covenant of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram and said, 'To your descendants I give this land, from the Wadi of Egypt to the great river, the Euphrates...'" - Genesis 15:18 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a covenant with Abraham. He made a promise. He made an agreement. He said, "To your descendants I give this land." It was a covenant. It was a promise. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance—now that he has died as a ransom to set them free from the sins committed under the first covenant." - Hebrews 9:15

Jesus is the mediator of the new covenant. He died to set us free. He made a new agreement. The covenant with Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need an agreement. Remember the covenant. Remember Jesus. He made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He made it with you.

Faith Builder
Think of a promise from God that you are holding onto. Write it down. Say it out loud. Thank God for making a covenant with you.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Thank you for the new agreement. Thank you for your blood. Thank you for your sacrifice. Help me to live in the new covenant. Help me to live in the new promise. Amen.

Day 23: The Sacrifice of Isaac

The Promise (OT)
"Then God said, 'Take your son, your only son, whom you love—Isaac—and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you.'" - Genesis 22:2 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God tested Abraham. He asked him to sacrifice his son. His only son. The son he loved. It was a test. It was a trial. It was a promise. It pointed to something greater.

The Proof (NT)
"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life." - John 3:16

Jesus is the only Son. He is the one who was given. He is the one who was sacrificed. The sacrifice of Isaac is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might wonder if God loves you. You might wonder if God cares. Look at the cross. Look at the sacrifice. God gave His only Son for you. That is how much He loves you.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "God loves me so much that He gave His only Son for me." Say it out loud. Thank Him for His love.

The Prayer
God, thank you for loving me. Thank you for giving your only Son for me. Thank you for the sacrifice. Thank you for the promise. Help me to trust your love. Help me to live in your love. Amen.

Day 24: The Ram in the Thicket

The Promise (OT)
"Abraham looked up and there in a thicket he saw a ram caught by its horns. He went over and took the ram and sacrificed it as a burnt offering instead of his son." - Genesis 22:13 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham looked up. He saw a ram. It was caught in a thicket. It was stuck. It was trapped. God provided the ram. God provided the sacrifice. It was a substitute. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, 'Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!'" - John 1:29

Jesus is the ram. He is the substitute. He is the sacrifice. He took our place. He took our punishment. The ram in the thicket is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a substitute. You might need someone to take your place. Remember the ram. Remember Jesus. He is the substitute. He took your place. He took your punishment. He took your sin.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "Jesus took my place." Say it out loud. Thank Him for being your substitute.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the ram. Thank you for being the substitute. Thank you for taking my place. Thank you for taking my punishment. Thank you for taking my sin. Help me to live in your sacrifice. Amen.

Day 25: The Promise of a Nation

The Promise (OT)
"I will surely bless you and make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore." - Genesis 22:17 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will surely bless you. I will make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky. As the sand on the seashore." It was a promise. It was a hope. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise." - Galatians 3:29

We are Abraham's seed. We are his descendants. We are part of the promise. The promise to Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are alone. You might feel like you do not belong. Remember the promise. Remember Abraham. You are part of a great family. You are part of the promise. You belong.

Faith Builder

Think about your church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the family. Thank you for making me part of your family. Help me to love my church family. Help me to serve them. Help me to belong. Amen.

Day 26: The Faith of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going." - Hebrews 11:8 (Written around 60 A.D.)

Abraham had faith. He trusted God. He obeyed. He went. He did not know where he was going. He did not know what would happen. But he trusted God. He had faith. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways submit to him, and he will make your paths straight." - Proverbs 3:5-6

Jesus is the object of our faith. We trust in Him. We lean on Him. We submit to Him. He makes our paths straight. The faith of Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might not know where you are going. You might not know what will happen. You might be afraid. Remember Abraham. He trusted God. He obeyed. He went. You can trust God too. You can obey. You can go.

Faith Builder
Think of a step of faith you need to take. Write it down. Ask God to help you trust Him. Ask Him to help you obey.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the example of Abraham. Thank you for his faith. Help me to trust you. Help me to obey you. Help me to follow you, even when I do not know where I am going. Amen.

Day 27: The Testing of Abraham

The Promise (OT)

"Some time later God tested Abraham. He said to him, 'Abraham!' 'Here I am,' he replied." - Genesis 22:1 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God tested Abraham. He tested his faith. He tested his trust. He tested his obedience. It was a test. It was a trial. It was a promise. It pointed to something greater.

The Proof (NT)
"Consider it pure joy, my brothers and sisters, whenever you face trials of many kinds, because you know that the testing of your faith produces perseverance." - James 1:2-3

Jesus is the one who helps us in our trials. He is the one who produces perseverance. The testing of Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might face trials. You might face tests. You might face difficulties. Remember Abraham. He was tested. He trusted God. You can trust God too. He will help you. He will produce perseverance in you.

Faith Builder
Think of a trial you are facing. Write it down. Ask God to help you trust Him. Ask Him to produce perseverance in you.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the example of Abraham. Thank you for his faith. Help me to trust you in my trials. Help me to trust you in my tests. Help me to trust you in my difficulties. Produce perseverance in me. Amen.

Day 28: The Obedience of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"Early the next morning Abraham got up and loaded his donkey. He took with him two of his servants and his son Isaac." - Genesis 22:3 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham obeyed. He got up early. He loaded his donkey. He took his servants. He took his son. He went. He obeyed. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"If you love me, keep my commands." - John 14:15

Jesus is the one we obey. We love Him. We keep His commands. The obedience of Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might wonder how to show your love for Jesus. You might wonder what to do. Remember Abraham. He obeyed. He showed his love by obeying. You can show your love by obeying. You can keep His commands.

Faith Builder
Think of one command of Jesus you can obey today. Write it down. Ask God to help you obey it.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the example of Abraham. Thank you for his obedience. Help me to obey you. Help me to keep your commands. Help me to show my love for you. Amen.

Day 29: The Provision of God

The Promise (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He saw God's provision. He saw God's faithfulness. He saw God's goodness. It was a promise. It was a hope. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus." - Philippians 4:19

Jesus is the provision. He is the one who meets our needs. He is the one who provides. The provision of God is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have needs. You might have worries. You might have fears. Remember the provision of God. Remember Jesus. He meets your needs. He provides for you. He takes care of you.

Faith Builder
Think of a need you have. Write it down. Ask God to provide. Thank Him for being your provider.

The Prayer
God, thank you for your provision. Thank you for meeting my needs. Thank you for taking care of me. Help me to trust your provision. Help me to trust your faithfulness. Amen.

Day 30: The Promise in the Garden

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

This is the first promise. This is the first gospel. This is the first clue. God spoke to the serpent. He spoke to the devil. He said a descendant would come. He said a hero would come. He said a rescuer would come. That descendant is Jesus. That hero is Jesus. That rescuer is Jesus. He is the promise in the garden.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the promise. He is the fulfillment. He was born of a woman. He crushed the serpent's head. He defeated the devil. He saved the world. The promise in the garden is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the fulfillment. He is the hope. He is the future. He is the promise in the garden.

Faith Builder
Write down one thing you have learned about the promise in the garden over the last 30 days. Thank God for the promise. Thank Him for Jesus.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise in the garden. Thank you for the first gospel. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the serpent's head. Thank you for saving the world. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Amen.

END MATTER

The 30-Day Promise Challenge
You have journeyed through 30 days of the promise in the garden. Now what? I challenge you to read the Gospel of John. It is 21 chapters. It is the perfect follow-up to this book. It shows you how Jesus is the fulfillment of every promise. As you read, look for the promise. Look for the clues. Look for Jesus.

A Note on Faith
The promise is evidence. It is evidence of a divine plan. But evidence does not save you. The promise points to a person. The promise points to Jesus. You can understand the promise and still miss the Savior. The invitation is for your heart. Jesus said, "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in." The promise is on the table. The door is open. It is your choice.

About the Author
[Author Name] loves helping new believers build a strong foundation. He believes that faith is not a blind leap. It is a confident step based on evidence. He lives with his family and enjoys hiking and reading.

Coming Next: From Creation to the Cross
If you enjoyed this journey, the next book in the series goes deeper. From Creation to the Cross takes a 30 day look at understanding the need for Jesus in Genesis. It is for the new believer who wants to go further.

Final Call to Action
Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of believers. The journey is not over. The adventure is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The New Believer Edition)

A soft, warm cream or light parchment background. A large, beautiful garden is in the center. In the middle of the garden is a tree. The tree has roots, a trunk, and branches. It is the tree of life. A bright light is shining from behind the tree. The title THE PROMISE IN THE GARDEN is in a strong, trustworthy, bold serif font. The subtitle is in a gentle, welcoming sans-serif. The overall feel is warm, inviting, and full of hope.